halilneed

Guide 1, 15 minutes, 4 steps

A business unit's first AI model

From one task to a pilot you can measure. For the people who run a process, not for the people who train models.
This PDF is the printed version of an interactive guide. To run the experiments yourself: **halilneed.agency/guides/first-model/**

Step 1 of 4

Which task first?

Pick a task. The task card fills itself in.

Task card

Sort emails | Pull fields from invoices | Summarise requests | Approve credit applications

Input	An incoming customer email
Output	One of six categories
Examples	50 or more labelled emails per category
Measure of success	Share in the right category, per category
Human check	When the model is unsure, a person takes it

✓ Repeats often ✓ Easy to check ✓ Cheap to get wrong

✓ A good first task

⚠ A good first task repeats often, has an output you can check and is cheap to get wrong.

Step 2 of 4

One score hides the weak cases

Look at the overall score, then split it into slices.

94%

Overall accuracy

Overall score | Split into slices



The figures are illustrative. I took my own Turkish personal-data model from 0.740 to 0.882 this way, without training a bigger model.

Not a bigger model: targeted examples for the weak slices.

Step 3 of 4

Which level to start at?

Answer three questions and the starting level lights up.

Does the input come in a fixed format? (date, IBAN, product code)	Yes	**No**
Do you have 100 or more labelled examples?	**Yes**	No
May the data leave the company?	Yes	**No**

Level 1

Rules

Fixed formats: dates, IBANs, codes

Level 2

A ready model and a prompt

No labelled data needed

Level 3

A small fine-tuned model

With labelled examples, in-house

Level 4

A custom model

High volume, a team and a budget

✓ **Level 3: You have examples and the data must stay in: train a small model.**

⚠ A first pilot almost never needs level 4.

Step 4 of 4

Shadow first, then assist

A pilot runs in two stages. Look at both.

Shadow mode | Assist mode



The model affects no one. For two to four weeks you collect scores, slice by slice.

One task, one measure

Read the score slice by slice

Watch in shadow mode first

Write the pass mark down first

Next: which model for which process

Six kinds of model and four questions that choose between them.

halilneed.agency/guides/model-map/

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